SYNTHETIC / ILLUSTRATIVE DATA - INVENTED FOR SIT COURSE PROJECT - NOT REAL SMF OPERATIONAL DATA

Singapore Manufacturing Federation

Grant Utilisation & Advisory Review

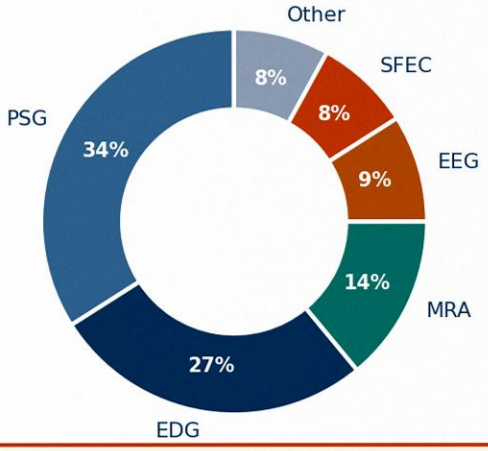
Financial Year 2025/26 · Member Advisory Services Division

Prepared for the SIT Industrial Attachment RAG proof-of-concept. All figures on every page of this document are invented. They are internally consistent so that retrieval and citation behaviour can be evaluated, but they describe no real member, officer or disbursement.

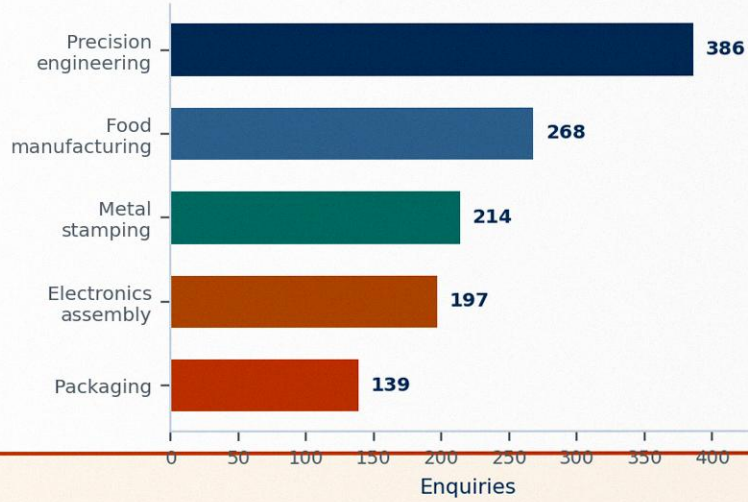
Headline figures

312	24	41 days	S$18.6m
members served at SMF Grant Clinics	Grant Clinic sessions held in FY2025/26	median PSG approval time observed	total grant value advised on

Advisory enquiries by scheme (n = 1,204)



Enquiries by member sub-sector



Key observation for the advisory team

PSG and EDG together account for 61% of all enquiries, yet EDG carries a rejection rate more than three times higher than PSG. The dominant EDG rejection reason - project already commenced - is entirely preventable at the advisory stage. SMF advisory officers should treat "have you signed anything or paid any deposit yet?" as the first question in every EDG conversation, before discussing eligibility or cost categories at all.

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1. Application outcomes by scheme

Applications SMF advisory officers supported to submission, FY2025/26.

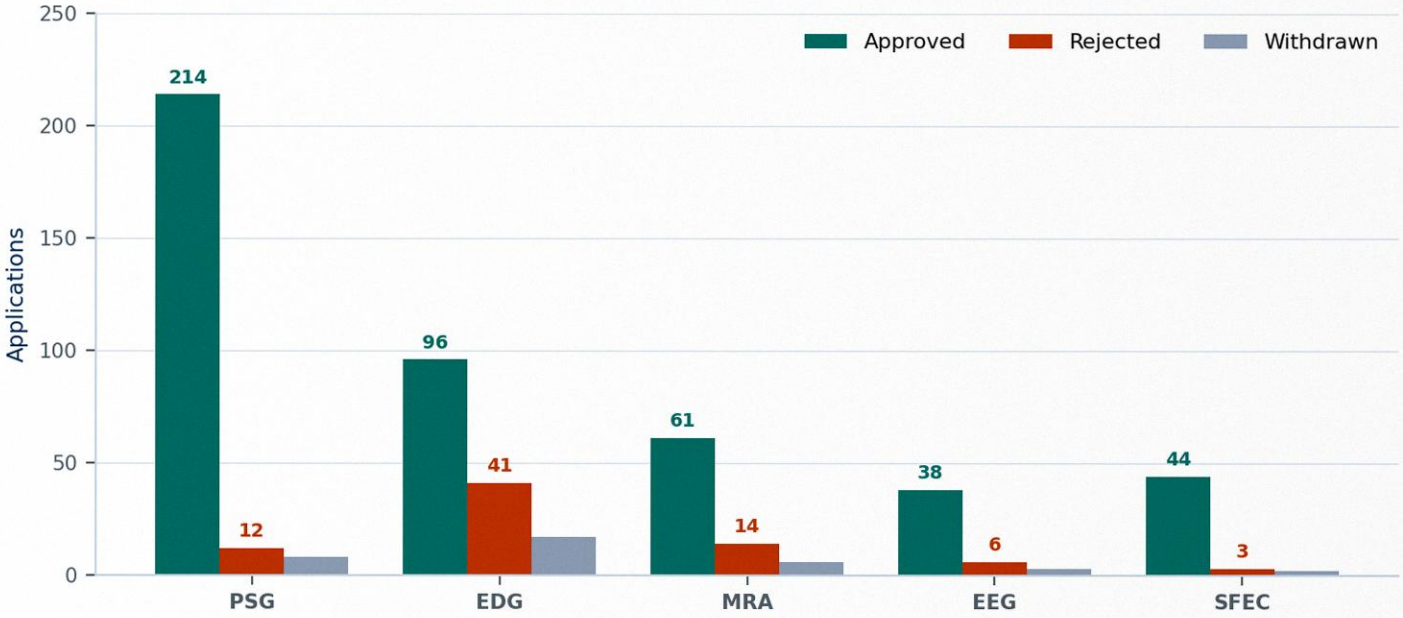
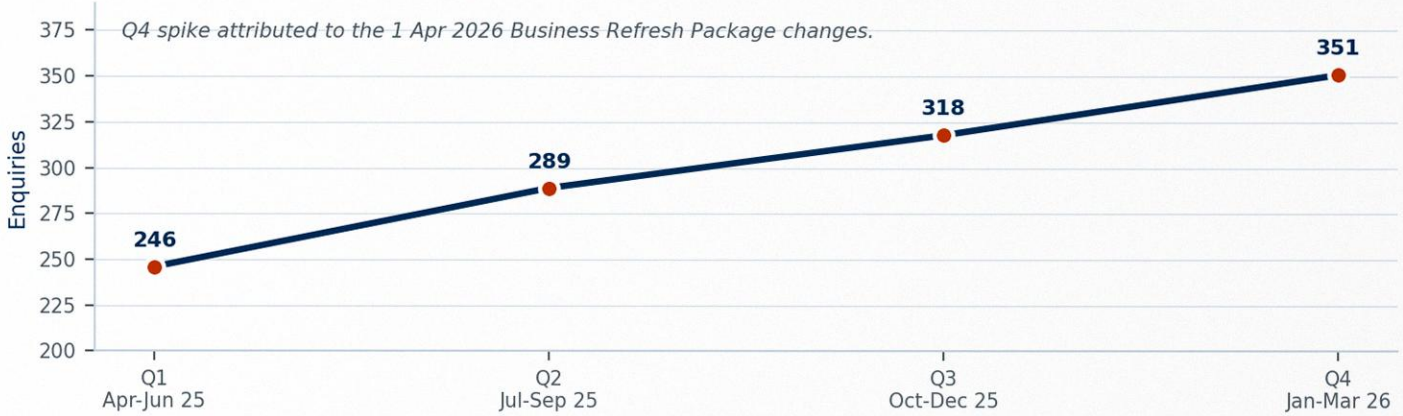


Table 1.1 Outcome rates by scheme

Scheme	Submitted	Approved	Rejected	Approval rate	Median days
PSG	234	214	12	91.5%	41
EDG	154	96	41	62.3%	78
MRA	81	61	14	75.3%	52
EEG	47	38	6	80.9%	45
SFEC	49	44	3	89.8%	22
TOTAL	**565**	**453**	**76**	**80.2%**	**-**

2. Quarterly enquiry volume

Seasonality matters for advisory staffing.

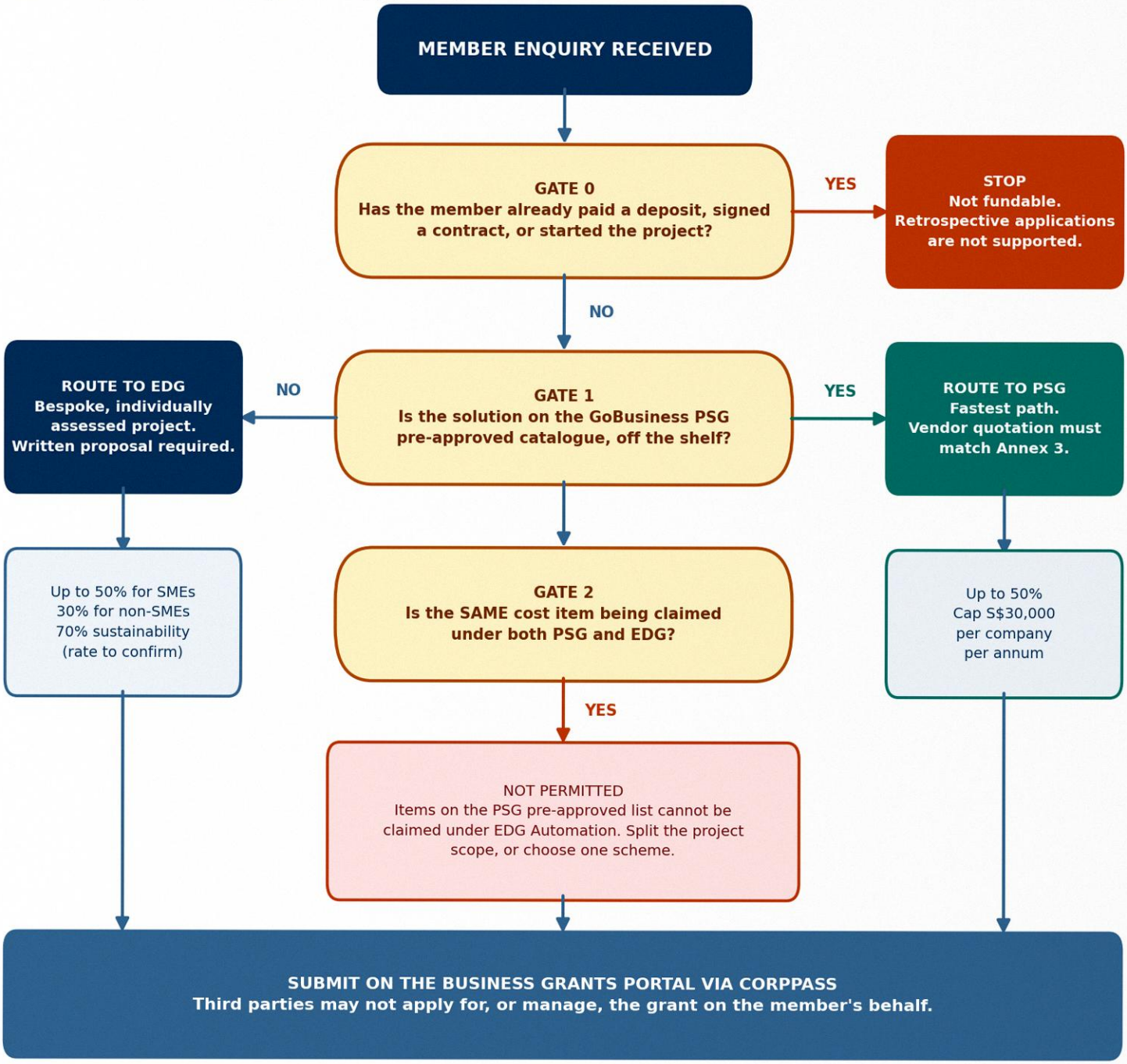


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3. Advisory routing decision tree: PSG or EDG?

The routing logic SMF advisory officers apply during a first member conversation.



Advisory note - the three questions that prevent most rejections

1. Have you paid anything or signed anything yet?
   Gate 0. Accounts for 34.2% of all EDG rejections - the single largest cause.

2. Is the company name on the quotation the exact ACRA-registered name?
   Accounts for 10.5% of rejections. "ABC Global" will be rejected if ACRA says "ABC Global Pte Ltd".

3. Is the consultant SAC-accredited under TR 43 or SS 680?
   EDG management consultancy costs only. Usually discovered too late, at claim stage.

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4. Rejection reason analysis

All 76 rejected applications, FY2025/26. Percentages are of rejections, not submissions.

TOP REJECTION REASON

34.2%

Project already commenced before application

26 of 76 rejections. Signing the vendor contract counts as commencement, even with no money paid. This single check would have saved an estimated S$1.4m of member funding.

Figure 4.1 Rejection reasons ranked

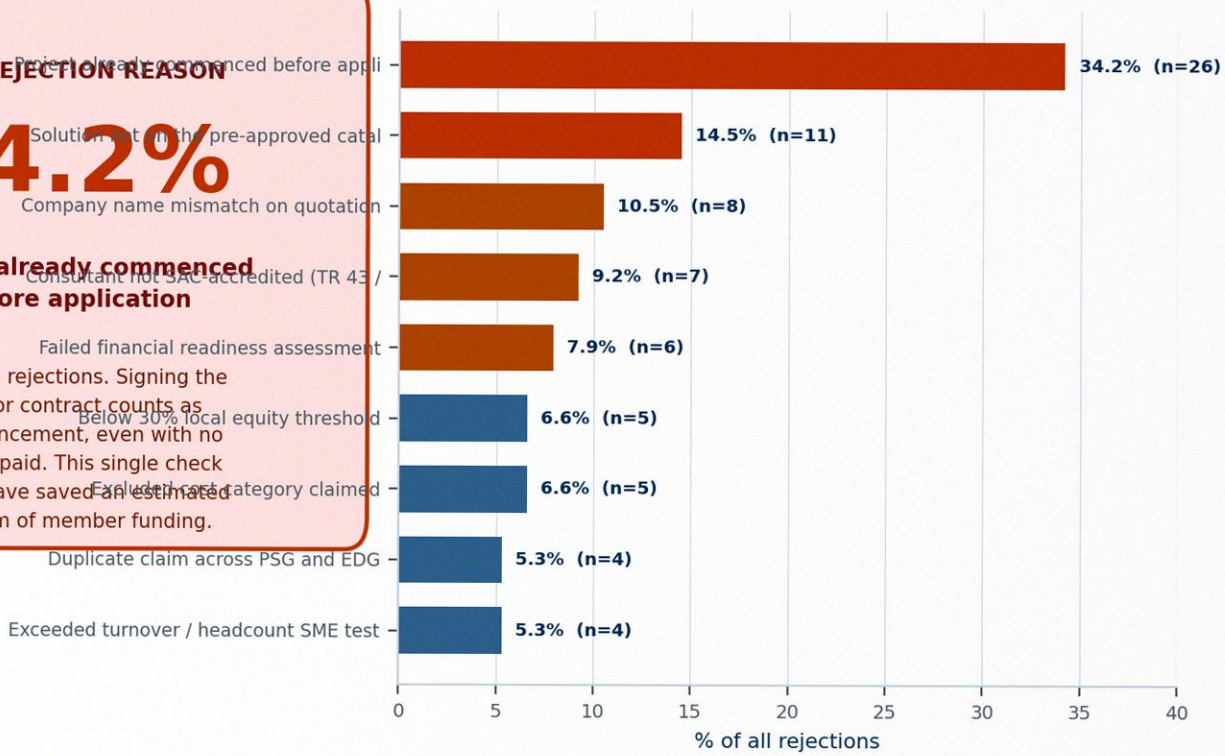


Table 4.2 Rejection reason by scheme (count)

Reason	PSG	EDG	MRA	EEG	SFEC
Already commenced	3	18	4	1	0
Not on catalogue	9	-	1	1	0
Name mismatch	5	2	1	0	0
Consultant not accredited	-	7	-	-	-
Financial readiness	0	5	1	0	0
Local equity below 30%	2	2	1	0	0
Excluded cost category	1	3	1	0	0
PSG/EDG duplicate claim	2	2	-	-	-
SME test exceeded	0	2	1	2	-
Column total	**22**	**41**	**10**	**4**	**0**

Corrective actions agreed for FY2026/27

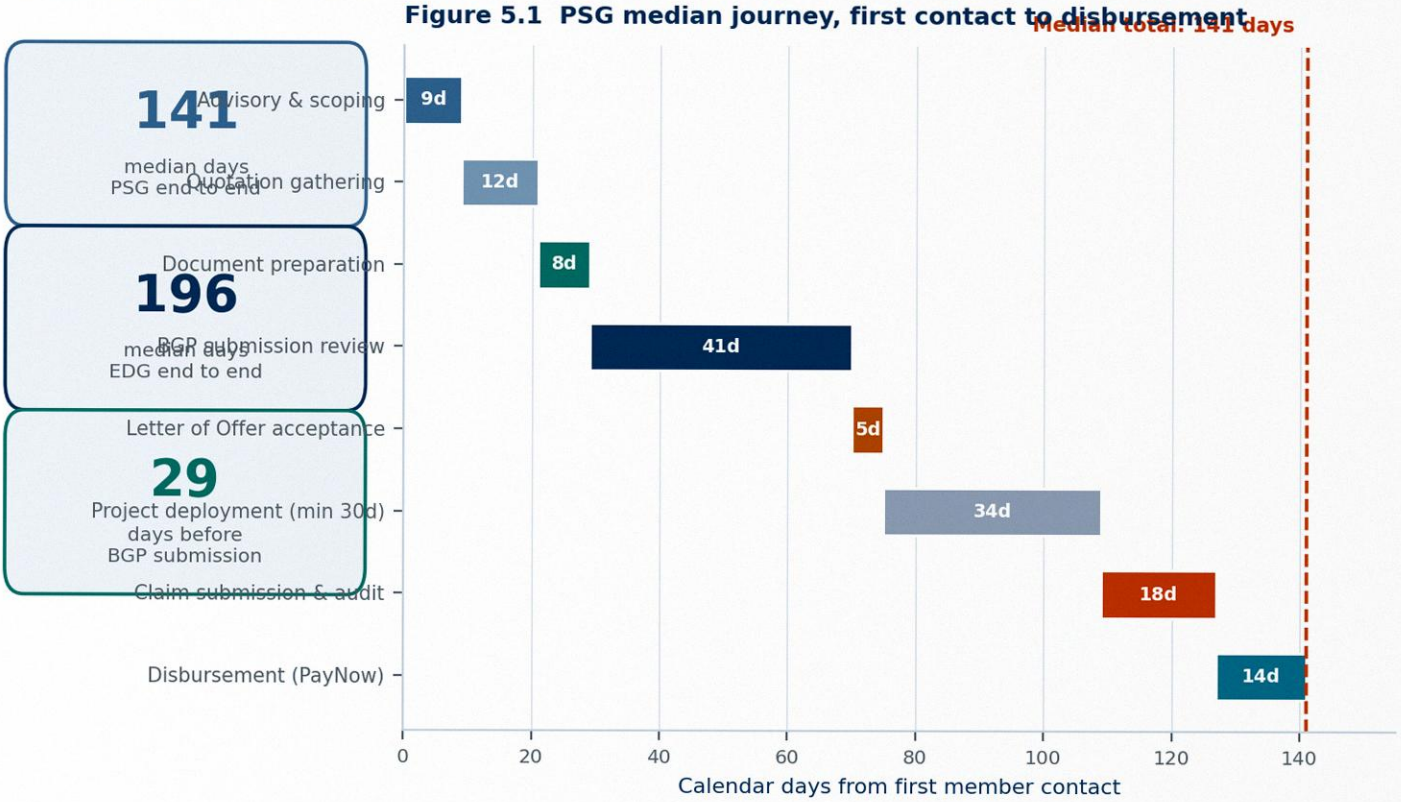
A. Mandatory commencement declaration on the SMF advisory intake form before any scheme is discussed.
B. Advisory officers to request the ACRA bizfile at first contact and pre-fill the exact registered name.
C. Maintain an internal list of SAC-accredited consultants known to SMF members, refreshed quarterly.
D. Escalate any member describing a project already underway to the EDG appeal pathway, not a new application.

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5. Observed end-to-end processing timeline

Median calendar days from member first contact to funds received. Illustrative.

Figure 5.1 PSG median journey, first contact to disbursement



6. What the numbers mean for the AI advisory assistant

The review makes three points that shaped the design of this proof-of-concept assistant.

Most failure is preventable, not technical.

Two thirds of rejections trace to four procedural checks that an assistant can ask about in the first thirty seconds of a conversation. The assistant does not need to be a grants expert to add value; it needs to be a reliable checklist that never forgets Gate 0.

Advisory volume is growing 43% year on year.

Enquiries rose from 246 in Q1 to 351 in Q4. SMF has no in-house technical team and cannot scale advisory headcount at that rate. Deflecting routine first-line questions is the clearest value case.

Wrong numbers are worse than no numbers.

A member who is told the wrong support rate may sign a contract on that basis and lose the whole grant. The assistant must therefore abstain rather than estimate, and must surface every TO VERIFY marker in the underlying advisory notes rather than smoothing it into a confident figure.

Document provenance

Every figure in this document is synthetic, generated on 27 July 2026 for the SIT RAG & Agentic AI mini-project. It is rendered as a rasterised image with no embedded text layer, so that the retrieval pipeline must recover its content by optical character recognition. Scheme mechanics referenced here are drawn from the verified text-layer advisory notes; the operational statistics are invented and describe no real member or disbursement.